FREE PLAY

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The “My plan” column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction, project overview, explore Logic, brainstorm ideas.	Slides 1–7: hook, what Free Play is, the production cycle, step 1, commit early. Hand out the project sheet and the Idea sketchpad. Students open Logic and try sounds.	Slides 1–7	p. 12, p. 15, p. 16, p. 17, p. 19
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Write and submit project proposals via your class page.	Slides 8–10: the three parts of a proposal, vague or clear, before you submit. Hand out the Proposal planner. Read each proposal before the student builds.	Slides 8–10	p. 13
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — compose, build, refine.	Slides 11–12: steps 3 and 4, and the worked example on paper. Hand out the Work plan. Then work time.	Slides 11–12	p. 14
CLASS 4		Slides 13–14: keep building, and mix time is not optional. Then work time.	Slides 13–14	p. 14
CLASS 5		Full working day: compose, build, refine. Ask each student to play you the track so far and say what is next.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix, bounce, and prepare presentations. Students write their 3 Padlet feedback questions.	Slides 15–17: mix and finalize, what to turn in, the rubric. Students self-score and post their three questions.	Slides 15–17	p. 18, p. 20
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 18–19: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate’s questions. Reflection (page 21) follows the presentations.	Slides 18–19	p. 20, p. 21

THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 2

Read every proposal before the student starts building. A one-sentence proposal goes back with a question (what will it sound like? which tools?), not a grade. The Proposal planner (page 13) has the frame.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days. Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate and use this project as a diagnostic: note who manages time, who needs structure and who is ready for more (my closing note).

PREVIEW

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FREE PLAY

Worked example · an invented piece

EXAMPLE

Teacher

An **invented piece, "Late Bus Home", described on paper**: no audio is included, so the numbers are easy to check. Students' projects will differ.

1 · A VAGUE PROPOSAL

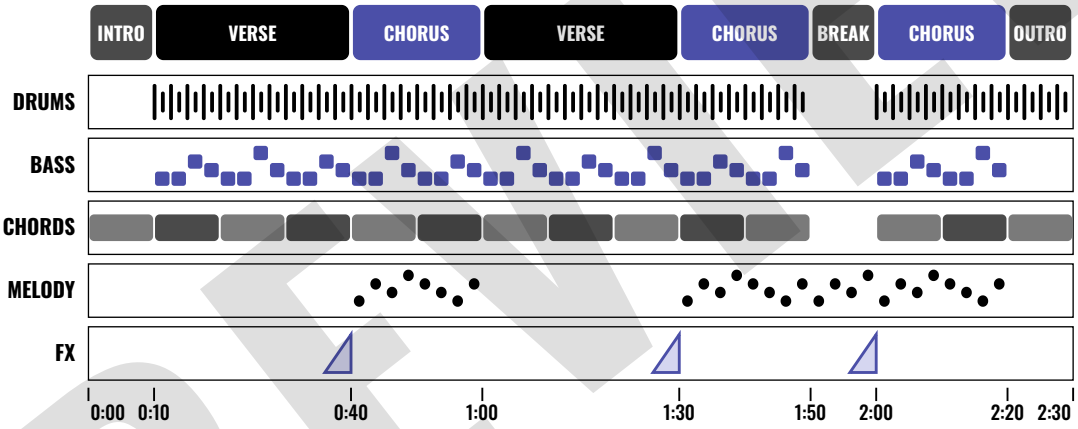
I will make a chill beat.

Nobody can say what it sounds like or which tools it needs.

2 · A CLEAR PROPOSAL (CONCEPT, TOOLS, SOUND)

I am making "Late Bus Home", a mellow instrumental about the ride home after a long day, about two and a half minutes long. I will start with a slow drum groove and a soft bass, add warm chords on a keyboard sound, and write a simple melody for the choruses. In Logic I will use drum sounds and software instruments, EQ to keep the bass from covering the chords, and panning to spread the parts out. It will sound relaxed and a little sleepy at 96 beats per minute, and it should get fuller each time the chorus comes back.

3 · THE ARRANGEMENT MAP: 2:30 ·



4 · CHECKING THE NUMBERS, AND WHY IT WORKS

96 beats per minute is 0.625 s a beat, so a bar of 4/4 is 2.5 s. Sections: 4 + 12 + 8 + 12 + 8 + 4 + 8 + 4 = 60 bars, and 60 × 2.5 s = 150 s = 2:30, as the proposal says. Every section has a job and something changes each time: layers enter, the melody arrives in the choruses, a riser leads into each chorus and the break strips the track back.

5 · A MIX PLAN: EQ, PANNING AND VOLUME ON EVERY TRACK ·

TRACK	VOLUME	PANNING	EQ
Drums	steady, under the melody in the choruses	center	cut a little of the muddy low-mids
Bass	just under the drums	center	roll off the highs so it stays out of the chords' way
Chords	softer than the melody	a little left and right	cut the lows so the bass has room
Melody	the loudest part in the choruses	center	lift the upper mids so it cuts through
FX	very quiet	wide	cut the lows so the risers stay light

6 · Three Padlet questions (invented): 1. Where did you first hear the track get fuller? 2. Which part would you turn up or down, and why? 3. Does the title match the way the track feels?

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FREE PLAY

Project sheet · requirements and steps

STUDENT

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Length is up to you — but your track should feel complete, not unfinished
- ☐ Use a variety of tracks and instruments appropriate to your chosen style
- ☐ Apply basic mixing: EQ, panning, and volume balancing on all tracks
- ☐ Write a project proposal paragraph (submitted via your class page)

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Explore** — Open Logic, experiment with sounds, and brainstorm ideas (Idea sketchpad: page 12)
2. **Propose** — Write a paragraph describing your concept, tools, and what the final product will sound like. Submit via your class page (Proposal planner: page 13)
3. **Build** — Lay down your foundation (drums, chords, bass) and begin shaping your arrangement (Work plan: page 14)
4. **Develop** — Add layers, melodies, FX, and transitions. Refine your sound and structure
5. **Mix** — Balance your levels, apply EQ and panning, and clean up your project
6. **Finalize** — Bounce your final track and prepare your presentation
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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FREE PLAY

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Free Play | Open-Ended Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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